

Risk Assessment

LANCASTER UNIVERSITY STUDENTS' UNION

Details	
Event/Project Name	Fire Sessions & Events
Group	Lancaster University Magic, Aerial and Circus Society (LUMACS)
Risk Assessment Review Date	21/09/26
Ongoing Assessment	
The Risk Assessment process <u>must</u> be 'on-going' and 'dynamic'. In other words, professional judgements and decisions regarding safety will need to be made <u>during</u> the activity. If the control measures aren't sufficient, the activity must not proceed. All personnel involved with the running of the event must receive very clear guidance and instructions for the management of the event and be very clear about their own roles and responsibilities for each aspect of the event and carry these out under the guidance given. The whole team must be told that under no circumstances are they to admit liability in case of any accidents; all incidents or questions involving insurance must be referred to LUSU the next day.	

Hazard	What are	Who is at	What are the controls and	Controlled	Controlled	Controlled	Who is responsible for
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	the risks and potential injuries?	risk?	actions? (use numbers)	severity	likelihood	Risk Rating	the control?
Hair catching fire	Burns	Individual using fire	1. Hair must be properly tied back before using fire 2. Individuals will not be able to use fire if they have used hair spray or hair gel in their hair recently 3. A spray bottle of water will be kept at hand to spray individuals hair before they start using fire	3	1	3	(1-3) Individuals using fire (3) LUMACS and health and Safety Regulatory Body
Clothes catching fire	Burns	Individual using fire	1. Individuals must wear clothing made from 80% cotton or higher 2. It is advised not to wear loose clothing 3. PPE will be provided to performers where necessary	3	1	3	(1-2) Individual using fire (3) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body
Surrounding area catching fire	Burns	Surrounding area, Individuals in vicinity	1. Fire blankets will be present and available for use 2. Sand buckets and water taps will be available next to the fire area 3. Relevant people will be contacted and informed of the date, time and location of any fire sessions taking place	3	1	3	(1-3) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body

			4. Fire sessions must only take place outside (well ventilated)				
Person using fire getting burned	Burns	Individuals using fire	1. Individuals can only use equipment after being signed off as safe to use by the LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body 2. There will be spotters stationed around the fire area 3. There will be a first aid kit with burn treatments available with an individual with a valid first aid training certificate present at all times 4. A fire blanket will be present and available for use 5. For second and third degree burn professional medical advice should be sought 6. If individual catches fire they must follow instructions given by the LUMACS and Health and Safety Body or do the most appropriate action in the situation, normally to stop using equipment and drop it	3	2	5	(1-5) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body (6) Individual using fire

Spotters getting burned	Burns	Individuals spotting fire use	1. Spotters will be aware of their surroundings 2. Spotters will stand a safe distance away from the individual using fire 3. There will be a first aid kit with burn treatments available with an individual with a valid first aid training certificate present at all times 4. A fire blanket will be present and available for use 5. For second and third degree burn professional medical advice should be sought 6. If individual catches fire they must follow instructions given by the LUMACS and Health and Safety Body or do the most appropriate action in the situation	3	1	3	(1-5) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory body (6) Spotter
Other individuals getting burned	Burns	Individuals in vicinity	1. The fire area will be clearly marked with spotters surrounding the area to warn individuals passing	3	1	3	(1) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body
Weather	Burns, Smoke inhalation	Individuals using fire, individuals in	1. Fire night will not go ahead if the weather is deemed unsafe e.g. if it is windy,	3	1	3	(1) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory

		the vicinity	raining, snowing or foggy (low visibility)				
Spilling paraffin	Paraffin fumes, potential for paraffin to set on fire resulting in burns and smoke inhalation	Individuals in the vicinity	1. The equipment will be squeezed of paraffin before being spun to avoid excess paraffin flying off, or a separate spin off area will be marked out, with only one individual in the area at one time 2. Wear protective equipment when handling paraffin 3. All clothes affected should be thoroughly rinsed with water and washed as soon as possible 4. Seek medical advice if paraffin is consumed or gets into eyes 5. The society has clean up material so will clean smaller spills and professional help will be sought out for larger spills	3	2	5	(1-5) Health and Safety Regulatory Body (2-5) Individuals using fire
Storing Paraffin	Paraffin spillage	Storage Building and surrounding buildings, Individuals in buildings	1. Paraffin will not be decanted into other containers for storage, unless it is in a proper sealed and labelled container meant for paraffin storage 2. Paraffin will be stored	3	1	3	(1-7) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body

			upright and sealed inside the locked LUMACS flammable cabinet, in the LUMACS fire cage. 3. Paraffin containers must be labelled clearly 4. Do not use the paraffin if it is in a broken container 5. No more than 20 litres of paraffin may be stored in one place without informing the fire brigade 6. Sawdust will be present and available for use to soak up any smaller leaks 7. Seek professional help if there is a spillage, in the meantime exec will use appropriate equipment to clean up the spillage as long as it is safe to do so				
Disposing of Empty Paraffin Bottles	Paraffin fumes and trace amounts of paraffin	Storage Building and surrounding buildings, Individuals in buildings	1. Empty bottles will be stored in the LUMACS fire cage. 2. When possible, contact the chemistry department to safely dispose of empty bottles. 3. Never store more than 4 empty bottles.	3	1	3	(1-3) LUMACS Health and Safety Body
Fire equipment storage	Excess paraffin	Storage Building and surrounding	1. Keep equipment in a cool environment not exposed to sun and high temperature	3	1	3	LUMACS Health and Safety Body

		buildings, Individuals in the building					
Faulty equipment	Burns, getting hit by equipment, dripping excess paraffin on the floor	Individuals in the vicinity	1. Only equipment deemed safe by the LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory body will be used 2. Equipment will be checked before each fire session to ensure it is safe to use 3. Individuals using the equipment should report to an exec member if they notice that a piece of equipment has/ is broken	2	2	4	(1-2) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body (3) Individuals using the equipment
Advanced moves	Burns, smoke inhalation	Individual using fire, individuals in the vicinity	1. Individuals have to be able to competently use their equipment dry spinning and signed off by the LUMACS Health and Safety Body before using fire 2. Individuals should only do moves they are comfortable with and can stop using the equipment at any point. They should inform an exec member if this is the case 3. The fire session will be on a small scale, with only 1-3 individuals using lit equipment at any one time	3	1	3	(1-4) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body) (2) Individuals using the equipment

			4. Multiple spotters will be present to spot every individual using fire at one time				
Smoke inhalation	Respiratory issues	Individuals in the vicinity	1. Paraffin will be used in fire sessions because it does not produce too much smoke 2. Individuals should be aware of wind direction and not stand in front of the blowing smoke 3. Always seek professional medical help if necessary 4. Fire activities must only be done outside (well ventilated area)	3	2	5	(1-3) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body (2) Individuals in the area
Fumes from paraffin	Respiratory issues	Individuals soaking equipment with paraffin	1. A gas mask will be present and must be used by the individual soaking the equipment in paraffin if they are around paraffin for an extended period of time 2. If the individual near the paraffin is feeling dizzy/ lightheaded/ unwell they are to inform someone and step away 3. Always seek professional medical help if necessary 4. Paraffin must only be used outside (well ventilated	3	2	5	(1-2) Individual soaking equipment in paraffin (3-4) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body

			area)				
Alcohol	Wouldn't be able to assess the risk themselves Unstable/ lack of coordination Injure themselves or others	Individual consuming alcohol, individuals in vicinity	1. Individuals are not allowed to use fire or spot fire if they have consumed alcohol 2. Alcohol is not allowed to be present in the vicinity	2	1	2	(1) Individuals wanting to use fire (1-2) Individuals in the vicinity
Perception altering drugs	Wouldn't be able to assess the risk themselves Unstable/ lack of coordination Injure themselves or others	Individuals consuming perception altering drugs, individuals in vicinity	1. Individuals are not allowed to use fire or spot fire if they have taken perception altering drugs	2	1	2	(1) Individuals wanting to use fire
Smoking	Creates a fire hazard	Individuals in vicinity	1. Individuals are not allowed to smoke in the fire area	1	1	1	(1) Individuals wanting to use fire (1) Spotters and audience

General and Accessibility

Hazard	What are the risks and potential injuries?	Who is at risk?	What are the controls and actions? (use numbers)	Controlled severity	Controlled likelihood	Controlled Risk Rating	Who is responsible for the control?
Injuries	Worsening previous injuries, falling, bruises	Individuals taking part who are already injured	1) Individuals who are injured should not attempt moves which may worsen their injury 2) Individuals should disclose any injuries to relevant individuals before the session starts	2	2	4	(1-2) Individuals with an injury using the equipment (1-2) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body
General Medical Conditions	Worsening condition, overexertion, fatigue	Individuals who have medical conditions	1. Individuals who have medical conditions should not attempt moves which may worsen their condition	2	2	4	(1) Individuals with existing medical conditions
Asthma	Struggling to breathe	Individuals with asthma	1. Individuals with asthma should have their inhaler on hand for activities where it may be needed 2. If struggling to breathe, individuals with asthma should stop what they are doing and take a	2	1	2	(1-2) Individual using the equipment with asthma

			break/drink water/use their inhaler				
Hypermobility	Pulling/ straining muscles, dislocation	Individuals with hypermobility	1. Individuals who have hypermobility should not overextend joints to avoid dislocations 2. Individuals with hypermobility should take a break if in pain	3	1	3	(1-2) Individuals with hypermobility
Fatigue (CFS or similar)	Overexertion	Individuals with CFS or similar health conditions	1. Individuals with CFS or similar conditions should only take part in what they feel they can manage 2. Individuals with CFS or similar conditions should take regular breaks when and if needed	2	2	4	(1-2) Individuals with CFS or similar conditions using the equipment
Injured/ worsened injury or medical condition during the fire session	Worsening previous injuries, falling, bruises, wor sening condition, overexertio n, fatigue	Individuals attending fire sessions	1. There will be a designated fully equipped first aid and burn kit that will always be available. At least one of the exec in the circus session will have an active first aid certificate.	1	1	1	(1) LUMACS Health and Safety Regulatory Body

Injuries obtained whilst partaking in fire activities	Injuring themselves or others	Individuals in the vicinity	1. Agree to terms and conditions 2. Purchase a membership 3. Must have a valid membership to attend any fire sessions	1	1	1	(1-3) Individuals turning up to sessions (2-3) LUMACS exec
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Sign Off

The undersigned believe this assessment to cover all significant risks associated with the above activity and accept their responsibilities for ensuring associated controls are in place

Authorisation			
Position	Print Name	Sign	Date
Health and Safety Officer	Charlie Rouen	C.Rouen	18/06/26
President	Ell Cleary	E F Cleary	3/06/2026

Please detail how this risk assessment will be communicated to all parties who must comply:

Communication			
Who needs to understand this assessment?	How will this be communicated to them?	Person Responsible	Date

LUMACS Exec Committee	Email	Health and Safety Officer	21/06/26
LUMACS members	https://lumacs.co.uk/documents/	President	21/06/26

Risk Rating Guide

Below is a simple guide to help risk assessors determine the risk rating of each hazard identified.

A Risk Assessment should be 'Suitable and Sufficient'. That is to say:

- ◆ It should identify the risks arising in connection with the activity.
- ◆ The level of detail included should be proportionate to the risk.
- ◆ It must consider all those who might be affected i.e. staff, students, etc.
- ◆ It should be appropriate to the activity and should identify the period of time for which it is to remain valid.;

Risk = Likelihood X Severity

Likelihood		The Severity		
Very Unlikely	0	No Action	No injury	0
Unlikely	1	First Aider	Bruising, minor cuts, grazes	1
Possible	2	Doctor	Strains, Sprains, concussion	2
Likely	3	A & E 1	Loss of consciousness, blood loss, burns, breaks or injury resulting in Visit to A&E. Other non-permanent chemical effects. Corrosive toxic, flammable substances, mild chemical irritation of eyes or skin. Harmful, irritant substances	3
Very Likely	4	A & E 2	Permanent /partial/total disablement or other reportable injury/disease	4

Certain	5
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Death	Single Death or Multiple Death	5
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Likelihood	Severity					
	De ath	A& E2	A& E1	Nur se Uni t	Firs t Aid er	No Acti on
Certain	25	20	15	10	5	0
Very Likely	20	16	12	8	4	0
Likely	15	12	9	6	3	0
Possible	10	8	6	4	2	0
Unlikely	5	4	3	2	1	0
Very Unlikely	0	0	0	0	0	0

Risk Rating	Score	Action
Trivial Risk	0 - 2	No further action required unless incidents occur
Low Risk	3 - 4	No additional controls may be needed overall, but specific hazards may be reduced. Monitoring is required to ensure controls are maintained. Review if an incident occurs or more effective controls become available.
Moderate Risk	5 - 10	Efforts should be made to reduce the risk over a defined period of time.
High Risk	12 - 16	Work should not be started until the risk has been reduced. If work is in progress Urgent action should be taken to reduce or control risks.
Intolerable Risk	20 - 25	The activity should cease until risks have been reduced to an acceptable level.